

The Coca-Cola Company

3Q25 First Impressions

KO just reported 3Q25 Comparable EPS of \$0.82 that bested us and consensus at \$0.78. The majority of the ~4c beat vs. our model stemmed from below-the-line, but better operating profit contributed ~0.5c as well.

Our Thoughts

Albeit against a lowered bar, KO's 1% UCV and 6% organic sales growth should be well received today. After flagging pockets of softness in Latin America and Asia Pacific over the summer, trends look to have sequentially improved in September. Big picture, we see this as all reflective of the macroeconomic environment and on the call this morning, we will be interested to hear more about what the company is doing to address affordability where it is a concern and emergent local competition. Though we expect tough comps will be flagged for 4Q, this is already contemplated in guidance and Street estimates and we continue to like the set up into year-end & for 2026.

Highlights

- Consolidated OSG +6% vs. our +5% led fully by better price/mix that more than offset a ~1-pt lag on concentrate vs. our model
- APAC OSG +7% vs. our +4%
- Consolidated operating margin +115 bps vs. our +85 bps despite gross margins that were ~50 bps below our forecast thanks to solid cost management. Marketing still up in the quarter.
 - Continued outperformance from North America (+190 bps vs. our +40 bps)

Lowlights

- Unit case volume +1% vs. our +1.7% (but came in ahead of BBG Consensus of 0.75%)
- LatAm OSG +4% vs. our +9.5%
- LatAm operating margin -630 bps vs. our +40 bps, EMEA -80 bps vs. our +50 bps and APAC -240 bps vs. our flat

2025 Guidance

Updated:

- Effective tax rate 20.7% (from 20.8%), not including impact of ongoing tax litigation
- CFFO of \$12 billion ex. fairlife payment (from \$11.7 billion)
- Free cash flow of ~\$9.8 billion ex. fairlife payment (from ~\$9.5 billion)

Reiterated:

- Organic revenue +5-6% (vs. our +5.1% & Consensus at +5.3%)
- Comparable constant currency EPS +8%
- FX headwind of 1-2% on net revenues (vs. our -1.8% & Consensus -1.7%) and a 5% drag on comparable EPS (vs. our -4.9%) based on current rates and including hedged positions

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KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 71.00
Price (20-Oct-25)	USD 68.44
Potential Upside/Downside	+3.7%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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BCI, US

- Structural headwind of ~1% on net revenues and comparable EPS
- Comparable EPS +3% that implies \$2.97 (vs. us at \$2.97 and Consensus at \$2.98)
- Capex of \$2.2 billion

4Q25 Guidance

- Slight FX tailwind to net revenues (vs. our +1.7%) and a 4-5% drag on comparable EPS based on current rates and including hedged positions

2026 Guidance

- Slight FX tailwind to net revenues (vs. our +0.2%) and slight tailwind to comparable EPS based on current rates and including hedged positions

KO 3Q25 Earnings Call Details:

Today @ 8:30 AM ET - U.S. Dial: 1-888-415-4465; International: 1-646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315.

Analyst(s) Certification(s):

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 20-Oct-2025, USD 68.44), Overweight/Neutral, CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)
Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)	Kenvue Inc. (KVUE)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)

Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Primo Brands Corporation (PRMB)	Procter & Gamble (PG)
Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)	The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)

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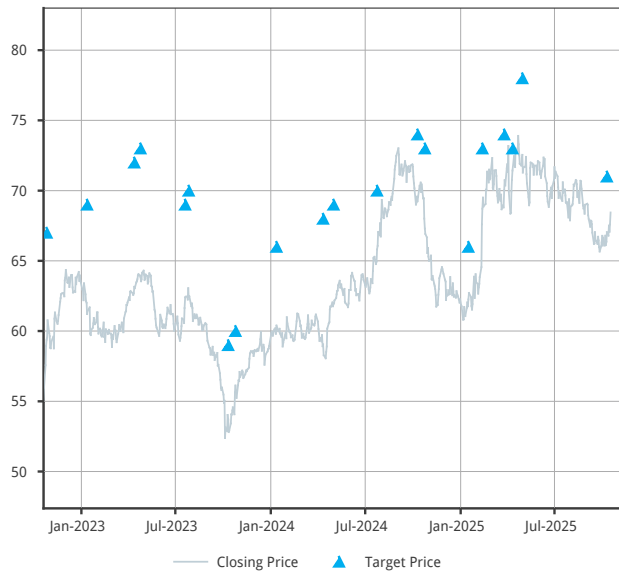
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 68.44** (20-Oct-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 20-Oct-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
10-Oct-2025	66.12		71.00
30-Apr-2025	72.35		78.00
11-Apr-2025	70.76		73.00
26-Mar-2025	68.95		74.00
12-Feb-2025	67.60		73.00
16-Jan-2025	61.77		66.00
24-Oct-2024	68.01		73.00
10-Oct-2024	69.57		74.00
24-Jul-2024	64.96		70.00
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00

On 21-Oct-2022, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 62.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$71 is based on a ~22.2x P/E reflecting a +HSD% premium to the more defensive, multinational peers on our CY26 EPS estimate of \$3.20.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) FX headwinds force downward revision of estimates, 2) Slowdown in CSD category growth, 3) More sugar taxes cloud the dialogue, 4) Deterioration in North American pricing environment would hurt results.

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